Willamette Falls Roofing

Roof leaking or storm-damaged? Do this first.

Print this and keep it somewhere you'll find it in the dark.

1. Safety first

☐ Stay off the roof, especially when it's wet, icy or covered in debris.

☐ If water is near light fixtures, outlets or the panel, switch off that circuit at the breaker.

☐ Keep everyone out of rooms where the ceiling is sagging.

☐ Stay clear of downed power lines and call your utility (PGE: 503-464-7777).

2. Stop the water spreading

☐ Put buckets, pots and towels under drips; move furniture and electronics out of the way.

☐ If a ceiling bulge is filling with water, poke a small hole at its lowest point with a screwdriver, with a bucket underneath, to drain it in a controlled way.

☐ Check the attic (if safe) and put a tray or tarp under the leak.

☐ Clear clogged gutters or downspouts only if you can do it safely from the ground.

3. Document everything

☐ Photos and video of the roof from the ground, the attic, and every damaged room, before cleanup.

☐ Note the date and time, and what the weather was doing.

☐ Keep damaged materials until your insurer says you can toss them.

☐ Save receipts for tarps, buckets, hotel stays and emergency repairs.

4. Call your insurer

☐ Report sudden damage (wind, falling limbs, ice) promptly and ask for a claim number.

☐ Ask what they need from you and whether they'll send an adjuster.

☐ A tree from a neighbor's yard? You still file with your own insurer (Oregon DFR).

☐ Stuck? Oregon's Division of Financial Regulation consumer help line: 888-877-4894.

5. Get a licensed roofer to tarp or patch

☐ Ask for an emergency tarp or temporary repair to stop more water getting in.

☐ Get the roofer's business name and Oregon CCB number and look it up at search.ccb.state.or.us.

☐ Don't sign anything on the spot that hands over your insurance claim, and don't pay large cash deposits.

☐ Ask for photos of the damage and of the temporary repair for your claim.

6. Plan the permanent fix

☐ Get a written estimate for the permanent repair or replacement.

☐ Compare at least two bids for big jobs; the CCB recommends getting several.

☐ Oregon requires a written contract for construction work over $2,000.

☐ Never pay the full amount up front.

> **Storm chasers:** Oregon's CCB warns that scam artists prey on storm victims. Check the license at search.ccb.state.or.us, get it in writing, and call your insurer before you hire.

Sources: Oregon Division of Financial Regulation (dfr.oregon.gov/insure/home/storm); Oregon CCB consumer tools (oregon.gov/ccb). Emergency? Call 911. Downed power lines: call your utility.

Willamette Falls Roofing is a local roofing information site, not a roofing contractor. Cost figures are published third-party estimates; only a licensed contractor's written bid is a price. willamettefallsroofing.com